Unit 15. Leaders of integrity (Action)

Overview

The module closes with a major emphasis of the pastorals and one that is central to the BUILD programme: integrity. And it provides an opportunity to review the module and the Pastoral Epistles from that perspective. Finally, it ends with a commitment to live out the truth of the gospel in ways that will build up other leaders and the churches.

Outline

- The meaning and importance of integrity
- Lessons on integrity in Module One
- Conclusion: Being leaders of integrity

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Define the meaning of the word integrity
2. Illustrate the meaning and importance of integrity from Module One
3. Repent of hypocrisy and commit to being a leader of integrity

15.1 INTRODUCTION: THE GOSPEL AND GODLINESS

"Preaching the Gospel and Godly Leadership" is this module's subtitle. From beginning to end the Pastoral Epistles are about the gospel and godliness. The gospel and godliness belong together: leaders must know and teach the true gospel and, strengthened by it, must live lives that illustrate the good news. The module's anchor verse makes that point:

> "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth." (2 Tim 2:15)

- Memorise that verse if you have not done so already.

- In what ways does the verse emphasise both what we <u>believe</u> and how we <u>behave</u> (the gospel and godliness)?

'Godliness' is just one of the words in the Pastoral Epistles that describes character that is based on the gospel.

- What other words in the Pastoral Epistles can you think of that describe what we must be like as leaders? Make a list of these words.

- How do we measure up to this list and how do other leaders around us measure up?

15.2 THE MEANING AND IMPORTANCE OF INTEGRITY

'Integrity' might have been one of the words in your list. In the situations we face locally in leadership it is one of the most important ones. It is found in Titus 2:7-8, which is given below. We will explore the meaning and importance of integrity, based on that passage.

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us." Titus 2:7-8

Remember, we have learnt that we can discover the meaning of a word by looking at the context it is used in. We will therefore ask and answer this question:

- What light does the context of Titus 2:7-8 shed on the meaning of the word integrity?

We will answer that question by working outwards from the smallest unit to the largest: from the phrase the word is set in, to the sentence it is set in, to the paragraph that provides its context, to the section of teaching that gives a wider context, to the argument of the book so far.

1. What do we learn from the phrase the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech..."

- What do you learn from this phrase?

2. What do we learn from the sentence the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this sentence?

3. What do we learn from the paragraph the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this paragraph, including its first sentence?

4. What do we learn from the section of teaching the word 'integrity' is set in?

Look at Titus 2:1-10.

- What do we learn about integrity from that section of teaching?

5. What do we learn about integrity from the argument of the book so far?

Look at Titus 1:1-16, the passage that leads up to the one we have been studying.

- What do you learn from the argument of the book so far?

- Sum up what you have learnt so far. What is integrity and why does it matter?

15.3 LESSONS ON INTEGRITY IN MODULE ONE

Because the gospel and godliness are central to the Pastoral Epistles it is no surprise that the idea of integrity has come up repeatedly. Take a look back through the module with these questions in mind:

- Where does the idea of integrity come earlier in the module?
- How do earlier units reinforce our learning about integrity?
- What new ideas about integrity do you notice from earlier units?

Use the blank spaces between the list of units below to make notes:

Unit 1. Introducing BUILD

Unit 2. How to hear God's voice today

Unit 3. Understanding 1 and 2 Timothy (Tools)

Unit 4. How to encounter a passage of the Bible

Unit 5. Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12

Unit 6. What is the gospel?

Unit 7. Sharing the gospel

Unit 8. Encountering 2 Timothy 2:1-7

Unit 9. Gospel centred ministry

Unit 10. Encountering 2 Timothy 3:14-17

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry

Unit 12. Encountering 2 Timothy 4:1-5

Unit 13. How to preach a passage of the Bible

Unit 14. Encountering Titus 1:5-9

15.4 CONCLUSION: BEING LEADERS OF INTEGRITY

Give time individually or in a group to committing yourselves to lives of integrity for the sake of God and the gospel. This will involve both repentance – turning away from hypocrisy and habits that undermine our integrity, and faith – trusting in God's strength and the power of his Spirit to live lives that will point to Christ and his kingdom. You might like to read some of these verses as your make this commitment:

"As for you, if you walk before me in **integrity** of heart and uprightness, as David your father did, and do all I command and observe my decrees and laws ..." (1 Kings 9:4)

"… you test the heart and are pleased with **integrity**." (1 Chronicles 29:17)

"I put in charge of Jerusalem my brother Hanani... because he was a man of **integrity** and feared God more than most men do." (Nehemiah 7:2)

"[Job] is blameless and upright, a man who fears God and shuns evil. And he still maintains his **integrity** ..." (Job 2:3)

"Relent, do not be unjust; reconsider, for my **integrity** is at stake." (Job 6:29)

"Judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, according to my **integrity**, O Most High." (Psalm 7:8)

"May **integrity** and uprightness protect me, because my hope is in you." (Psalm 25:21)

"In my **integrity** you uphold me and set me in your presence forever." (Psalm 41:12)

"And David shepherded them with **integrity** of heart; with skilful hands he led them." (Psalm 78:72)

"The man of **integrity** walks securely, but he who takes crooked paths will be found out." (Proverbs 10:9)

"The **integrity** of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity." (Proverbs 11:3)

"No one calls for justice; no one pleads his case with **integrity**. They rely on empty arguments and speak lies; they conceive trouble and give birth to evil." (Isaiah 59:4)

"They came to him and said, "Teacher, we know you are a man of **integrity**. You aren't swayed by men, because you pay no attention to who they are; but you teach the way of God in accordance with the truth. Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar or not?" (Mark 12:14)

"In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness ..." (Titus 2:7)

Review questions for Module One

- Look back through the titles of the units in the module. Which units had the greatest impact on you and why is that the case?

- Think back to your time in and use of the module. In what ways has your leadership been challenged and changed as a result of the module?

- In a similar way, reflect on the ways in which your church has been influenced by any teaching from the module, which you have passed on in some way.